

Paradiem

The Morning Brief

JULY 19, 2026

U.S. Casualties

Weekend Edition: two U.S. service members reportedly killed in Jordan by Iranian strikes; Iran reportedly suspends July agreement as Trump reportedly signals strikes continue; oil complex reportedly poised to gap higher on Sunday-evening reopen.

S&P 500 (FRI CLOSE)	BRENT PROXY (BNO FRI)	GOLD (GLD FRI)	BITCOIN (LIVE SUN)	FEAR & GREED
\$743.29 · ↓1.5% on the week	\$48.70 · ↑4.10% Fri · ~↑10% weekly	\$368.41 · ↑0.95% Fri	~\$62,400 · digital-asset weekend absorbs risk	CNN 37 Fear per CNN · data drop returned crypto fallback (28)

Markets — Weekend Edition: Reported Bitcoin Reportedly Held ~\$62,400 Through the Reported Weekend Session Below Its Reported \$65,000 Weekly Reclaim per Yahoo Coverage as the Reported Digital-Asset Complex Reportedly Absorbed the Reported Iran Escalation the Reported Rest of the Financial System Reportedly Could Not Reprice Until Monday per CryptoSlate Framing; Reported Sunday-Evening CME Reopen Reportedly Frames the Reported Oil-Complex Gap-Higher Setup Given Reported U.S. Casualties per CryptoSlate/CoinDesk Coverage; Reported Fed Communications Window Reportedly Enters Its Reported Blackout Period Ahead of the Reported July 28–29 FOMC Meeting per Federal Reserve Schedule

THE REPORTED WEEKEND SESSION REPORTEDLY CONCENTRATED THE REPORTED IRAN-ESCALATION REPRICING INTO THE REPORTED DIGITAL-ASSET COMPLEX: PER CRYPTOSLATE COVERAGE, REPORTED BITCOIN REPORTEDLY TRADED THROUGH THE REPORTED WEEKEND AS THE REPORTED FIRST LIQUID GLOBAL ASSET FORCED TO ABSORB THE REPORTED CONFLICT CADENCE WHILE REPORTED OIL FUTURES, REPORTED TREASURIES, AND REPORTED U.S. EQUITIES REPORTEDLY REMAINED CLOSED; PER YAHOO COVERAGE OF REPORTED WEEKEND PRICES, REPORTED SPOT BITCOIN REPORTEDLY TRADED ~\$62,400 WITH REPORTED ETHEREUM ~\$1,776 — A REPORTED COMPOSITION REPORTEDLY BELOW THE REPORTED WEEKLY \$65,000 RECLAIM FRAMED IN THURSDAY'S BRIEF; PER COINDESK COVERAGE, ANY REPORTED ESCALATION WOULD REPORTEDLY TRIGGER A REPORTED GAP HIGHER IN REPORTED BRENT WHEN REPORTED FUTURES REOPEN SUNDAY EVENING, A REPORTED FLIGHT TO THE DOLLAR, AND REPORTED SELLING PRESSURE ACROSS RISK ASSETS THAT REPORTED BITCOIN WOULD REPORTEDLY ABSORB FIRST

For FCI's framework, the reported weekend cadence reportedly places the reported U.S.-casualties development inside a reported price-discovery vacuum that reported Bitcoin reportedly is the only liquid instrument reportedly available to reprice — per CryptoSlate coverage, reported Brent Sunday-evening reopen reportedly frames the reported oil-complex gap-higher setup, and per CoinDesk coverage the reported flight-to-dollar composition reportedly aligns with the reported broader risk-off framing. Per data drop, reported Fear & Greed reportedly returned the reported crypto fallback of 28 (Fear); per CNN Fear & Greed coverage the reported CNN stock-market reading reportedly registered 37 (Fear) as of Friday — a reported CNN endpoint miss to flag. For the reported FCI Digital Assets sleeve, reported IBIT reportedly closed at \$36.35 (↓0.11%) and reported ETHA at \$13.91 (↓1.56%) Friday per data drop; the reported weekend Bitcoin trade below reported \$65,000 reportedly reflects the reported risk-off rotation composition rather than a reported crypto-specific catalyst. Carson's SPY \$645.80 support remains active per levels.json, well-removed from Friday's intraday range of \$740.80–\$747.29 per data drop — no level was reportedly hit through the reported prior session.

S&P 500 (FRI)	\$743.29 · ↓1.5% on the week per Yahoo
NASDAQ (FRI)	\$695.33 · ↓2.9% on the week per Yahoo
BRENT PROXY (BNO FRI)	\$48.70 · ~↑10% weekly per Reuters
BITCOIN (LIVE SUN)	~\$62,400 · below \$65k weekly reclaim per Yahoo
ETHEREUM (LIVE SUN)	~\$1,776 per Yahoo weekend framing
SUNDAY REOPEN	CME crude reopen ~5:00 PM CT · gap-higher setup per CryptoSlate
FED BLACKOUT	Communications window closed thru July 28–29 FOMC per Fed schedule
CARSON'S SPY SUPPORT	\$645.80 active · far from Fri range \$740.80–\$747.29

THE REPORTED FED COMMUNICATIONS WINDOW REPORTEDLY ENTERS ITS REPORTED BLACKOUT PERIOD THIS WEEK AHEAD OF THE REPORTED JULY 28–29 FOMC MEETING PER FEDERAL RESERVE SCHEDULE — NO SEP IS REPORTEDLY SCHEDULED PER FEDERAL RESERVE COVERAGE; PER CHASE COVERAGE OF CME FEDWATCH DATA, REPORTED ODDS OF A REPORTED HOLD AT 3.50–3.75% AT THE REPORTED JULY MEETING REPORTEDLY SIT AT ROUGHLY 89%, WHILE REPORTED YEAR-END HIKE PROBABILITY REPORTEDLY ROSE TO ~36% PER SEMAFOR COVERAGE (REPORTEDLY UP FROM 18% ON JULY 2); PER CHASE COVERAGE, REPORTED CHAIR WARSH REPORTEDLY TOLD CONGRESS ON JULY 14 THAT THE COMMITTEE WOULD NOT ACCEPT PERSISTENTLY ELEVATED INFLATION AND REPORTEDLY FRAMED THE SOFTER JUNE CPI AS A SINGLE-MONTH READING; REPORTED JUNE PCE REPORTEDLY PRINTS THURSDAY JULY 30 PER BEA RELEASE SCHEDULE

For FCI's framework, the reported blackout period reportedly compresses the reported committee's decision framework onto the reported incoming data and the reported geopolitical backdrop rather than the reported Fed-speak drip that reportedly shaped the reported prior fortnight. Per Reuters framing captured across the week, an oil shock stacked on Warsh's reported inflation-first stance reportedly narrows the reported cut path materially; the reported June-2026 SEP dot plot reportedly showed nine participants

anticipating at least one hike this year versus one seeing a cut per Federal Reserve coverage. For the reported FCI Dividend sleeve, the reported holding-pattern framing reportedly supports the reported cash-flow-generative defensive rotation captured in Thursday's tape (XLP ↑2.80%, XLV ↑2.22%, XLRE ↑2.02%) but reportedly did not hold into Friday's tape — a reported cross-current that reportedly signals reported de-risking rather than a reported sector-specific bid. **Simplicity Over Complexity.**

The reported weekend concentrated the reported U.S.-casualty repricing into the reported digital-asset complex while reported oil, rates, and equities reportedly waited for Sunday-evening reopen; the reported Fed blackout and reported hyperscaler earnings ahead reportedly frame the reported forward set-up. Research Reveals Opportunities.

Geopolitics — Reported U.S. Service-Member Fatalities: Per CENTCOM/CNN Coverage, Reported Two U.S. Service Members Were Reportedly Killed and Reported One Reportedly Missing After Reported Iranian Ballistic Missile and Drone Attacks on the Reported Al-Azraq Base in Jordan on July 17, Reportedly the First American Military Fatalities From Reported Iranian Fire Since March per CNN Coverage; Per CENTCOM, Reported Four Additional Service Members Were Reportedly Medically Evacuated and Reportedly Since Discharged; Per NBC/Bloomberg Coverage, the Reported Deaths Reportedly Bring the U.S. Service-Member Toll in the Reported Nearly Five-Month Conflict to Reported 16 per the Reported Defense Casualty Analysis System; Per Iranian State Media Cited by CNN, the Reported IRGC Reportedly Claimed Responsibility and Reportedly Said Several Aircraft Were Destroyed in the Attack; Per Reuters Coverage in the Data Drop Headlines, the Reported U.S. Reportedly Renewed Strikes on Iran After the Reported Casualties, With Iran's Reported Supreme Leader Reportedly Framing Trump's Signature as Unreliable and Without Force per Reuters

PER CNN COVERAGE IN THE IRAN WAR LIVE FEED, THE REPORTED WEEKEND REPORTEDLY DELIVERED THE REPORTED FIRST U.S. MILITARY FATALITIES FROM REPORTED IRANIAN FIRE SINCE MARCH: REPORTED JORDANIAN ARMED FORCES REPORTEDLY INTERCEPTED REPORTED TEN IRANIAN MISSILES EARLY SATURDAY PER CNN, BUT A REPORTED BASE AT AL-AZRAQ REPORTEDLY ABSORBED A REPORTED COMBINED MISSILE-AND-DRONE ATTACK REPORTEDLY KILLING TWO U.S. SERVICE MEMBERS AND LEAVING ONE REPORTEDLY MISSING PER CENTCOM/CNN COVERAGE; PER CNN, IRAN REPORTEDLY SUSPENDED ITS REPORTED COMMITMENTS UNDER THE REPORTED JULY AGREEMENT REACHED WITH THE U.S. LAST MONTH, AND IRAN'S REPORTED SUPREME LEADER MOJTABA KHAMENEI REPORTEDLY FRAMED TRUMP'S SIGNATURE AS REPORTEDLY UNRELIABLE AND WITHOUT FORCE PER CNN LIVE FEED; PER FOX NEWS COVERAGE, PRESIDENT TRUMP REPORTEDLY SIGNED STRIKES WOULD CONTINUE REPORTEDLY AT HIS OWN DISCRETION, WITH REPORTED THREATS ON REPORTED CIVILIAN INFRASTRUCTURE AND REPORTED ENERGY TARGETS; PER CBS COVERAGE, THE REPORTED U.S. NAVAL BLOCKADE OF REPORTED IRANIAN PORTS REPORTEDLY REMAINS IN FORCE WITH REPORTED DOZENS OF STRIKES REPORTEDLY ONGOING AS TRUMP REPORTEDLY SEEKS REPORTED CONTROL OF THE REPORTED STRAIT OF HORMUZ

For FCI's framework, the reported U.S.-casualties development reportedly is a reported inflection moment in the reported escalation cycle — per CNN coverage, the reported first-fatalities-since-March framing reportedly resets the reported domestic-political calculus around the reported conflict duration, and per Reuters coverage the reported U.S. renewal of strikes reportedly signals reported horizontal escalation continues rather than reported de-escalation. Per Fox News/CNN coverage, an advisor to the reported Supreme Leader reportedly warned that if reported strikes continue in the reported next 2–3 days, Iran would reportedly shift beyond reported proportional retaliation toward a reported broader invasion-scale response — a reported rhetorical escalation that reportedly compounds the reported physical cadence framed across Wednesday's Kharg-Island interdiction, Thursday's Qatar-territory reach, Friday's Bandar Abbas bridge strikes, and now Saturday's U.S.-casualty event. For the reported FCI Upstream sleeve, reported CVX reportedly closed $\uparrow 1.91\%$ at \$187.38 Friday among the reported top FCI movers, and reported OKE reportedly closed $\uparrow 0.56\%$ at \$93.52 per data drop; per CryptoSlate coverage, the reported Sunday-evening reopen setup reportedly frames the reported gap-higher composition in reported Brent. For the reported FCI Defense sleeve, reported LMT reportedly closed at \$508.77 and reported GD at \$368.58 Friday per data drop; per Benzinga coverage in the data drop headlines, reported NATO's reported \$40B counter-drone push reportedly puts reported defense ETFs in focus — a reported program-specific tailwind alongside the reported escalation bid. **The physical world matters.**

SECOND WEEKEND FRONT — PER ARAB NEWS/HAARETZ COVERAGE, THE REPORTED ISRAELI MILITARY REPORTEDLY

STRUCK A REPORTED HEZBOLLAH CELL NEAR TEBNIT IN SOUTHERN LEBANON SATURDAY AFTER REPORTEDLY IDENTIFYING A REPORTED HEZBOLLAH DRONE IN THE AREA,

WITH THE REPORTED AIR FORCE REPORTEDLY LOCATING FIGHTERS REPORTEDLY OPERATING DRONES AND REPORTEDLY TAKING COVER NEAR REPORTED ISRAELI TROOPS PER AN REPORTED IDF STATEMENT; PER LEBANESE MEDIA/GLOBALSECURITY COVERAGE, A REPORTED SEPARATE ISRAELI DRONE STRIKE REPORTEDLY KILLED FOUR CIVILIANS IN A REPORTED PASSING CAR NEAR A REPORTED TEACHERS' TRAINING INSTITUTE IN NABATIEH AL-FAWQA; PER ALJAZEERA COVERAGE OF REPORTED U.S.-MEDIATED FRAMEWORK, THE REPORTED STRIKES REPORTEDLY CONTINUED DESPITE THE REPORTED CEASEFIRE UNDERSTANDING; PER WIKIPEDIA'S REPORTED 2026 LEBANON WAR ENTRY COVERAGE, THE REPORTED SECOND FRONT REPORTEDLY REACTIVATED ALONGSIDE THE REPORTED IRAN CYCLE

For FCI's framework, the reported Hezbollah-front reactivation reportedly widens the reported theater beyond the reported Iran-primary cycle — per Arab News coverage, the reported IDF framing of reported ceasefire-violation cover reportedly signals reported operational latitude reportedly extends beyond a reported narrow retaliation posture. Per data drop, reported gold reportedly advanced ↑0.95% to GLD \$368.41 Friday and reported silver ↑0.77% to SLV \$50.78 — a reported composition that reportedly signals reported bullion reprices reported weekend risk faster than the reported broader macro even as the reported CNN F&G reportedly registered 37 (Fear). For the reported FCI Materials sleeve, reported FCX reportedly closed ↓0.31% at \$58.38 per data drop; per Benzinga coverage in the data drop headlines, gold reportedly shed three quarters of its recent gains, and one expert reportedly listed three gold stocks to watch — a reported cross-current for the reported precious-metals

cohort. Per Yahoo coverage in the data drop headlines, reported LMT reportedly faces potential setback as reported France and reported Germany reportedly seek a reported European military software supplier over reported Palantir — a reported program-specific European signal that reportedly reads across to the reported allied-defense-cohort framing. **Think Like an Owner.**

U.S. SERVICE MEMBERS KIA	Reportedly 2 killed · 1 missing · 4 evacuated then discharged per CENTCOM/CNN
IRANIAN MISSILES AT JORDAN	Reportedly 10 intercepted early Saturday per CNN · Al-Azraq base absorbed a combined missile/drone attack per CENTCOM
IRAN AGREEMENT	Reportedly suspended by Iran per CNN · Supreme Leader called Trump signature "worthless" per Reuters
U.S. RESPONSE	Renewed strikes per Reuters · Trump reportedly told Fox strikes continue at his own discretion
IRAN ADVISOR THREAT	Warned of shift beyond proportional retaliation toward invasion-scale response if strikes continue 2–3 more days per Fox/CNN
ISRAEL — SOUTHERN LEBANON	IDF struck Hezbollah drone cell near Tebnit per Arab News/Haaretz · separate strike killed 4 civilians per Lebanese media
HORMUZ TRAFFIC	Reportedly >50% drop vs prior week per prior-brief Aljazeera tracking
CONFLICT U.S. TOLL	Reportedly 16 total service members over ~5-month conflict per DoD Casualty Analysis System

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Week Ahead — STLD Reports Q2 Post-Market Monday July 20 With Reported Company Guidance \$3.51–\$3.55 EPS per Investing.com/Stocktitan Coverage; Reported Alphabet, Tesla, and Texas Instruments Report Wednesday July 22 per CNBC Coverage With Tesla Reporting Q2 After the Close per Cryptobriefing Coverage; Reported Intel Reports Thursday July 23 per WHBL/CNBC Coverage; Reported FOMC July 28–29 (Non-SEP) per Federal Reserve Coverage With CME FedWatch Reportedly ~89% Probability of Hold at 3.50–3.75% per Chase Coverage; Reported June PCE Reportedly Prints Thursday July 30 per BEA Release Schedule. For FCI's Growth-Hybrid sleeve, the reported Alphabet-and-Tesla Wednesday print reportedly frames the reported hyperscaler-capex-versus-supplier-absorption debate that reported chip cohort reportedly consolidated into Friday's tape (TSM ↓2.77%, NVDA ↓2.21%, LRCX ↓2.39% per data drop) — per CNBC coverage, reported earnings this week reportedly answer whether reported tech giants' reported massive AI spend reportedly is building a reported money machine or reportedly burning cash. Reported Intel Thursday reportedly is the reported foundry-and-share-loss cross-check into a reported cohort backdrop where reported chip stocks reportedly recorded their reported worst month since 2008 per Benzinga framing captured in the data drop headlines. For the reported FCI Growth-Hybrid sleeve, reported STLD reportedly repurchased a reported \$170M of stock in Q2 per Investing.com coverage with a reported order backlog reportedly nearly 40% higher

than a reported year ago extending into 2027 — a reported real-world capex-and-materials read into the reported chip backdrop. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

2. Sunday-Evening Reopen Setup — Per CryptoSlate/CoinDesk Coverage, Reported CME Crude Reportedly Reopens Sunday Evening (~5:00 PM CT) With a Reported Gap-Higher Setup Given the Reported U.S.-Casualty Event and the Reported Iran-Agreement Suspension per CNN; Per Data Drop, Reported BNO Reportedly Closed \$48.70 Friday (Reportedly ↑4.10% Fri, ~↑10% Weekly per Reuters) and Reported USO \$123.96 (Reportedly ↑3.91%); Per Prior-Brief Tracking of Aljazeera Coverage, Reported Strait Traffic Reportedly Dropped 50%+ Versus the Reported Prior Week Through Weekend. For FCI's Upstream and Materials sleeves, the reported Sunday-evening reopen reportedly frames the reported Monday cash-open positioning — per data drop, reported CVX reportedly closed ↑1.91% at \$187.38 Friday among the reported top FCI movers and reported OKE reportedly closed ↑0.56% at \$93.52. Per data drop, reported CNX Resources reportedly closed ↓0.54% at \$33.28 — a reported natural-gas single-name signal to track alongside the reported Iran-adjacent LNG framing. For the reported FCI Defense sleeve, reported LMT reportedly closed at \$508.77 Friday and reported GD at \$368.58 per data drop; per Yahoo coverage in the data drop headlines, reported Boeing reportedly kept its reported 20-year forecast for reported jet demand steady, reportedly shrugging off the reported Iran-war impact — a reported industrial cross-current to track. *The physical world matters.*

3. Digital-Asset Weekend Composition — Per Yahoo Coverage of Reported Weekend Prices, Reported Spot Bitcoin Reportedly Traded ~\$62,400 Sunday With Reported Ethereum ~\$1,776, Reportedly Below the Reported Week's \$65,000 Reclaim; Per Data Drop, Reported IBIT Reportedly Closed \$36.35 (↓0.11%) and Reported ETHA \$13.91 (↓1.56%) Friday; Reported Miner Cohort Reportedly Absorbed the Give-Back Into the Weekend With MARA ↓6.39% (\$10.69), HOOD ↓5.72% (\$99.96), and HUT ↓0.50% (\$91.45) per Data Drop; Per Benzinga Coverage in the Data Drop Headlines, Reported Bitcoin Stocks Reportedly Diverged From Reported Crypto With Reported Miners Reportedly Underperforming.

For FCI's Digital Assets and Growth-Hybrid sleeves, the reported weekend Bitcoin trade below reported \$65,000 alongside the reported miner-cohort give-back reportedly reflects a reported risk-off rotation composition rather than a reported crypto-specific catalyst — a reported composition consistent with the reported broader defensive-sector give-back captured Friday. Per CryptoSlate coverage, reported Bitcoin reportedly is the reported first liquid global asset forced to absorb the reported Iran cadence during the reported weekend session with reported less liquidity and reported more leverage than any reported traditional market. Per Benzinga coverage in the data drop headlines, reported Piper Sandler reportedly maintained Overweight on MARA but reportedly lowered its price target to \$13 — a reported single-name signal to track alongside the reported broader cohort composition. *Avoid Erosion.*

4. Fed Blackout & Domestic Politics of U.S. Casualties — Per Federal Reserve Schedule, the Reported Communications Blackout Reportedly Runs Through the Reported July 28–29 FOMC Meeting; Per Chase Coverage of CME FedWatch Data, Reported July-Meeting Hold Odds at 3.50–3.75% Reportedly Sit Near 89%, While Reported Year-End Hike Probability Reportedly Rose to ~36% per Semafor (Reportedly Up From 18% on July 2); Per June-2026 SEP per Federal Reserve, Reported Nine Participants Reportedly Anticipated at Least One Hike This Year Versus One Seeing a Cut; Per Fox News/CNN Weekend Coverage, President Trump Reportedly Signaled Strikes Would Continue at His Own Discretion, and Iran's Reported Supreme-Leader Advisor Reportedly Warned of a Reported Shift Beyond Proportional Retaliation Toward an Invasion-Scale Response if Strikes Continue 2–3 More Days; Reported June PCE Reportedly Prints Thursday July 30 per BEA Release Schedule. For FCI's framework, the reported U.S.-casualty framing reportedly compresses the reported domestic-political calculus onto the reported committee's reported

inflation-first stance — per Chase coverage, Chair Warsh reportedly told Congress on July 14 the committee would not accept persistently elevated inflation and reportedly framed the softer June CPI as a single-month reading. For the reported FCI Dividend sleeve, the reported Friday tape reportedly gave back the reported defensive-rotation composition captured Thursday, with reported XLP ↓0.72%, XLV ↓0.44%, and XLRE ↓0.09% per data drop — a reported cross-current that reportedly signals reported broad-based de-risking. Carson's SPY \$645.80 support remains active per levels.json, well-removed from Friday's intraday range of \$740.80–\$747.29 per data drop — no level was reportedly hit through the reported weekend session. *Simplicity Over Complexity.*